

600 Medical Coding

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will demonstrate their knowledge and skills in medical coding through theory and application questions utilizing ICD-10-CM and CPT code sets. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this application event.

Contestant Must Supply

- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials
- (Optional) Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See NLC Calculator Guidelines. Contestants who violate this rule will be disqualified.
- Suggested resource: Manual ICD-10-CM (2025) and CPT (2025), only physical copies allowed, no electronic references

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: objective | application
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for an event will be allowed in the testing area
- No previous Business Professionals of America tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) may be taken into the testing area. Violation of this rule will result in disqualification.
- Length of event: no more than ten (10) minutes orientation, no more than sixty (60) minutes testing time, no more than ten (10) minutes wrap-up
- Entries vary by state

Contest Competencies

1. Define current coding terminology, symbols, and abbreviations
2. Apply proper sequencing principles using medical coding guidelines
3. Demonstrate medical coding knowledge and skills using ICD-10-CM and CPT in diverse scenarios, assigning codes accurately to ensure compliance with official guidelines and audit standards
4. Identify and interpret coding systems based on structure, format, and context, distinguishing both diagnostic and procedural code sets